

License Information Documents

How to find
IBM licensing
information

User Guide

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Overview

Use of IBM programs is governed by specific terms and conditions, and each program has a detailed document setting out specific terms that apply to that individual program. These documents are known as “License Information Documents” or “LI Documents”.

This guide is intended to help clients locate the relevant License Information Documents for their deployed programs, understand the structure and content of License Information Documents and their specific obligations when deploying IBM Programs. This document is not intended to provide advice for specific client circumstances. Always consult your IBM representative should you have any questions or concerns about the specific terms applied to your IBM estate.

Key Terms

The following terms are used throughout this document and are fundamental to understanding its contents.

Announcement Letter

A document which announces the release of a new (or updated) IBM program. Available on the [IBM Offering Information](#) portal.

International Passport Advantage Agreement (“IPAA”)

An agreement which sets out licensing terms for all IBM programs licensed under the Passport Advantage program. It is available [here](#).

International Program License Agreement (“IPLA”)

An agreement setting out the base terms for all IBM programs licensed under PA, PAE and certain mainframe programs. It is available [here](#).

License Information (“LI”) Documents

A document which sets out detailed licensing information about an IBM program. Each document relates to a specific release (version). LI documents are defined in the [IPLA](#), Part 1 (General Terms), clause 1 and in the [IPAA](#), sections 3 and 3.2.

SLA

Software License Agreement

Introduction

License Information Documents (“LI Documents” or “LIs”) are offering-specific agreements that set out the terms that govern the use of IBM software licensed under the International Program License Agreement (“IPLA”). Each program has a detailed LI Document that sets out any specific terms that apply to the program in addition to those in IPLA.

LIs are provided with IBM software in either hard or soft copy. The terms and conditions set out in the LI must be accepted prior to the software being installed or used. Additionally, LIs for all software announced or released after May 1999 are available online in a [searchable repository](#).

There are over 30,000 LIs, with more being added when new programs are introduced or when new software versions are released. LIs are issued for each major and minor version release, meaning that a single program will often have multiple LI Documents and it is important to ensure that you are looking at the correct document for the program that you have deployed.

While LIs are primarily contractual documents they also contain useful practical information regarding the specific product offerings.

LIs should be the first reference point for product-specific licensing queries.

Detail

Searching for LIs

All LIs can be searched for and viewed in the online repository located [here](#). To search the repository, click on “Search for a specific LI”. The search page is located [here](#).

Given the size of the repository and the many different possible search terms for programs, versions and editions of IBM programs, it is important to try to optimize the search keywords as much as possible to reduce the number of false positives.

Here are some general tips:

Be specific...

Searching for ‘DB2’ will result in many search results being returned. A more precise query of ‘DB2 Advanced Enterprise Server’ will return a much smaller population which is easier to parse and much more likely to be related to what you are searching for.

... but not too specific!

While tempting, including the program name, edition and version number is likely to return no hits. Focus on the program name and edition, and visually find the correct version from the results.

Use the Program Number

If you know the Program Number (“Part ID” or “PID”), this is the easiest way to get to the list of LIs for the program you’re searching for. The Announcement Letter for the program will detail the PID.

For more detailed advice, see the guidance [here](#).

Interpreting Search Results

Search results are displayed in a table, with a row for each LI document matching the search. Each row includes the Program Name, Program Number, and the date that the Announcement Letter was released for that specific Program Number.

The search results are presented in descending order, with the most recently released / announced programs appearing at the top of the search results. When selecting the relevant row, pay close attention to the following elements of the Program Name as many programs have multiple permutations, and the differences can be subtle:

Elements of the Program Name	Examples
Program Version	Both major and minor version numbers
Program Edition	"... Standard Edition", "... Advanced Edition"
Platform	"... for Linux, Unix and Windows", "... for z/OS"
Environment	"... for Non-Production Environments", "... for Developers"

Clicking on the Program Name will redirect you to a page asking you whether you want to see the base license agreements or the License Information document. The License Information document is selected by default, so you simply click 'Submit'. The LI document will then be displayed in the next page.

The Structure of a LI Document

The content of a LI document has remained consistent for many years but there may be slight differences in the layout, format and wording depending upon when it was published.

LI documents form part of the license agreement under which you are permitted to use the IBM program, so they are detailed contractual documents. As a result, they can be lengthy and need careful reading to identify the information that is relevant to your question. The length of a LI document depends on the complexity of the licensing of the Program. LIs can sometimes run across multiple pages. Subsequent pages can be navigated by using the 'Next' link at the bottom of the page.

LI documents always begin with the Program Name and Program Number.

In some instances, LI documents may be applicable to multiple IBM Programs. This generally occurs when there are several programs in a 'product family' and the same terms apply to all programs (or they share a common set of terms with specific terms relating to individual programs set out in respective sections of the document).

If this is the case, then the name of each applicable program will be listed, as shown on the next page.

LICENSE INFORMATION

The Programs listed below are licensed under the following terms and conditions in addition to those of the IBM International Program License Agreement (IBM form number Z125-3301-14).

Program Name: IBM WebSphere MQ V8.0

Program Number: 5724-H72

Program Name: IBM WebSphere MQ Telemetry Client V8.0

Program Number: 5724-H72

Program Name: IBM WebSphere MQ Advanced Message Security Component V8.0

Program Number: 5724-H72

Program Name: IBM WebSphere MQ Idle Standby V8.0

Program Number: 5724-H72

Program Name: IBM WebSphere MQ Advanced Message Security Component Idle Standby V8.0

Program Number: 5724-H72

<http://www-40.ibm.com/software/sla/sladb.nsf/lillookup/B98DDD49D918456D85257D8F00338C7B?OpenDocument>

Key Licensing-Related Information

Below are some of the key sections to look for in LI documents which relate to licensing. There may be other sections in specific LI documents which are not covered here.

License Metrics	The description of the various metrics under which the program can be licensed. The metric determines the data which is needed to measure usage of the program. Where there are multiple possible metrics, consult your entitlement records or Proofs of Entitlement to understand which metric you have licensed the program under.
Bundled Programs / Supporting Programs	Where relevant, these sections set out the list of any additional IBM programs which are included within the license to provide functionality or capability to the licensed program. There are often further sections in the LI document which explain any associated licensing terms and conditions for these bundled or supporting programs. These should be read carefully as it is a common area of compliance issues among IBM clients. Bundled and Supporting Programs are discussed in detail in the licensing guide available on the Guides page.
Prohibited Components	Sometimes there are portions of the program (or portions of the bundled or supporting programs) which the license does not grant you permission to use. These are listed in this section. Use of any of these components means that the program either becomes separately licensable (in the case of a bundled or supporting program) or requires a different license type (for example, a higher edition).
Restrictions and Specific Requirements	The LI document will set out any specific restrictions or requirements that apply to the program. These restrictions vary between programs. Common examples include: – Limitations on the processing capacity of the machine – Limitations on the amount of memory installed on the machine – Restriction to use only in a non-production environment – A requirement to hold entitlements to another program (a “prerequisite program”).
Standby, Backup and Disaster Recovery	IBM’s policy relating to standby, backup and disaster recovery configurations is set out in a separate document. This is discussed in more detail in the licensing guide available on the Guides page. Some LI documents do set out specific guidelines for the individual IBM program. The terms of the LI document supersede the general policies.
Non-Production Licenses	If the program is available under a specific non-production license, a section will exist in the LI document which sets out the restrictions relating to these licenses. Non-productive use of IBM programs is discussed in further detail in the licensing guide available on the Guides page.
Evaluation Terms	If a program is available for a trial, or evaluation period, then a section of the LI document will explain how long this evaluation period lasts. Typically, this is 90 days, but it can vary. Where a LI does not include terms for evaluation, you may contact your IBM representative or an authorized IBM reseller to request a temporary evaluation license. This is also discussed in more detail in the Non-Productive Use licensing guide referenced above.
Components that do not require licenses	The section “Components Not Used for Establishing Required Entitlements” sets out, if applicable, any components that may be installed without requiring a license to the program.

FAQs

Where do I go to find the License Information Document from my deployed IBM Programs?

The License Information Document Repository on the IBM SLA web page. This can be found [here](#).

Why are there many License Information Documents for the Program I am searching for?

Additional License Information Documents are issued for every version of a program released. It is important to refer to the License Information Document for the exact version deployed.

How do I get access to an LI published prior to 1999?

LIs or equivalents prior to 1999 must be requested from IBM.

How can I find out how to measure the license requirement for my deployed IBM Programs?

License Information Documents set out the License Metrics used to measure Program usage. The LI will provide a definition of the metric and an explanation of the measurement criteria, for example, Number of Activated Processor Cores, Number of Users and Number of Managed Devices.

However, the description of the license metric does not always explain how the relevant information should be gathered or interpreted in order to calculate the license requirement. Some knowledge of how the program operates and the reporting capabilities of the program may be necessary in order to access the required information. Where metrics are based upon the processing capacity made available to the program, it is the infrastructure used to deploy the program which needs to be measured.

For more general information about the approaches to measuring license use, please see [this](#) page.

Further Reading

LI Document Search Tips

Tips to help you get the results most relevant to your search

<http://www-40.ibm.com/software/sla/sladb.nsf/sla/searchtips/>

Base License Agreements

A page that contains links to the license agreements that underpin the licensing of IBM software

<https://www-40.ibm.com/software/sla/sladb.nsf/sla/bla?OpenDocument>

LI Document Repository

A searchable repository of License Information documents

<https://www-40.ibm.com/software/sla/sladb.nsf/sla/home?OpenDocument>

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Not all offerings are available in every country in which IBM operates.

IBM Licensing and User Guides provide general guidance to help clients navigate common IBM licensing and compliance topics. The guides’ content is provided for general information purposes only and is not intended as legal advice. IBM reserves the right to review the materials from time to time and to amend them to reflect changes in IBM’s licensing terms.

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Questions and Comments:

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